When your war is over (I'll still be there)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/62954587.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Categories:
F/F, Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Catra & Melog (She-Ra), Adora & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra & Melog (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra), Darla | Mara's Ship (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Minor Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), Catra Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Catra Gets a Hug (She-Ra), Adorable Adora (She-Ra), Lesbians in Space, Outer Space, Mentioned Horde Prime (She-Ra), Nightmares, fluffbruary's Fluffbruary Prompt Month 2025, Fluffuary | Fluffy February 2025, Femslash February, Established Relationship, Pillow Fights, Domestic Fluff, Fluff and Humor, Romantic Fluff, Therapy Cat Melog (She-Ra), Catra & Glimmer Friendship (She-Ra), Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Catra is a Dork (She-Ra), Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Adora is a Dork (She-Ra), Adora is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Useless Lesbians, Canon Lesbian Relationship, Magic, Community: halfamoon, Post-Canon, Canon Compliant, Fluff and Angst, Best Friends, Recovery, Mind Control Aftermath & Recovery, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Post-War, Soft Catra (She-Ra), Soft Adora/Catra (She-Ra), IN SPACE!, Catra Acts Like a Cat (She-Ra), Song: In Our Bedroom After the War (Stars), Sharing a Bed, Everything is Beautiful and Nothing Hurts, Mild Hurt/Comfort, Flashbacks, catra hates cold and space is cold

Language:
English

Collections:
February Ficlet Challenge 2025, Feveruary 2025, Femslash February, Fluffbruary 2025, Fandom-Free Bingo (Half-Baked Edition), Half a Moon: 14 Days of Celebrating Women

Stats:
Published: 2025-02-11 Words: 1,358 Chapters: 1/1

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by lyricalark

Summary

Catra, Adora, and life in space after the war

Notes

Catradora and the Best Friends Squad IN SPACE!!!
Title from in our bedroom after the war by Stars:
https://youtu.be/qotDKQHxySk?si=dTcf7UabxsVvigJA

This fulfills a lot of February writing challenges
February Ficlet Challenge: making our own traditions
Fandom-free Bingo Half-baked Edition: pillow fight
Fluffbruary: coat
Fluffuary: reassurance
Fluffy February: rivals
Halfamoon: domestic life
Femslash February 2025: astral
Feveruary: you're safe, it was just a dream
Minifemslash February: trust me
Fluffruary: quiet company
Femslash February: stars

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra does not like space. Being stuck in Darla for long periods of time reminds her of those awful months on Prime's ship. She's not sure if it's the inability to leave or the lack of stable ground that makes it worse. There's also the privacy issue.

She and Adora have the storage room they renovated for her after - after the rescue. The bunker room is for Sparkles and Arrow Boy - *Bow and Glimmer*, their names are important for her to know now*, so many* new things are important for her to know now.

She volunteers for the spacewalk maintenance once just to get out. Once is enough - she's still tethered to the ship and she can't feel the air on her fur and it's just bad, okay. The stars don't help - they're so cold and distant they feel almost unreal.

Adora finds her huddled under their blankets with Melog after. Melog runs to Adora, headbutts her, and purrs. Adora smiles.

Catra thinks she would stay in space forever if it meant causing those smiles.

"Hey, Catra," Adora says softly. "I'm going to sit down now. You don't have to tell me what's wrong, but I'm here, you can trust me, I'll always be here."

Adora sits. Catra still can't wrap her brain around a universe where those words are true.

I'll always be here. You can trust me.

She nestles up against Adora and dozes off as her partner strokes her fur, still trying to find the words to say 'I believe you' and mean them.

***

Catra wakes up screaming. There's something in her neck and she can't get it off. She tries to claw at her throat and something stops her hands.

“Catra, *Catra*, it's okay, you're safe, *Catra*, *stop*!” a voice is saying.

She screams again. “Let go of me!”

“Not until you promise not to hurt yourself,” Adora says. Because it's Adora, of course it's Adora, she never listens and Catra *told her* not to come and now -

“Catra,” says Adora softly. “Look at me.”

Catra looks up. Adora is smiling down at her with messy loose hair and magic glowing in her eyes. Catra can see the faint astral glow of She-Ra’s power outlined above them, but Adora hasn't summoned the sword. She lets go of Catra's hands and lowers her to the bed gently, like she's something precious.

I want to kiss her, the thought slices through her delirium. She thinks it again. *I want to* kiss her.

“You’re safe,” Adora repeats. “It was just a dream. He's gone.”

“He's gone?” Catra hates how small and uncertain her voice comes out, like a kitten's mewling.

“He's really gone,” Adora nods. “You kinda, um, helped me stop him and save all of Etheria. Do you, um, do you want me to remind you how or should I wait for it to come back?”

Catra kisses her. She remembers all of it.

“Exactly like that,” Adora breathes. Her face takes on a mischievous look. “Although, maybe we should do it again, just to be sure.”

“You are *such* an idiot,” says Catra weakly. Then she kisses her again, because she's not going to turn down that opportunity.

They sit together quietly, Adora talking about nothing and Melog draped across both their laps, until it feels like it should be sunrise but isn't.

“I hate being in space,” Catra says. “Too many memories, too cold, and there's no way to mark the time. I need to be somewhere else.”

“Okay,” Adora nods firmly as she pulls her hair back into its tight poof. She tosses Catra her red jacket and Catra wraps it around herself gratefully. That helps with the cold, at least. “Do you want to go back to Etheria?”

“No!” Catra yelps. “I mean, I want to stay with you.”

Adora needs to be in space. It's part of her mission as She-Ra. Catra can't be the reason she gives up now.

“We could come up with ways to mark the time,” Adora tilts her head. “Traditions of a sort. I know you and I are both still on the Fright Zone’s schedule, but there's no reason we have to keep following it.”

“As if you would ever stop getting up to train,” Catra points out, but there's no heat behind it.

Adora shrugs. “Fair, but there's no reason I have to do it their way, you know? We can make our own time now.”

She pauses. “Glimmer’s gonna be so mad. She's been trying to get me to relax for years and it turns out the reason I couldn't is - is because you weren't there to remind me.”

Catra can't do anything after that except kiss her. Their lips meet and Catra pretends not to notice the healing magic that transfers between them. She's getting used to it.

She's starting to believe in Adora. In their *love*, which is maybe the sappiest thing she's ever admitted but it's true.

“This might be because I like you,” she mutters.

“What was that?” Adora sounds amused, like she definitely heard her.

Catra whacks her with the pillow.

“Oh it's *on*,” Adora wrests the pillow from her grasp. They chase each other around the room, grabbing for the pillow. Melog joins in, headbutting Adora until she's doubled over enough that Catra can even reach, yowling merrily the whole time.

“What are you *doing*?” Glimmer appears in the doorway. “*Some of us* are *trying* to *sleep*!”

“Oh, is that what you and Arrow Boy were doing in there?” says Catra innocently. “Because it sounded like you were both *very* awake.”

“Oh it is *on*, Horde Scum!” Glimmer teleports to grab the pillow and slams it into Catra's face. Catra digs her claws into it and *pulls*.

It explodes, sending feathers flying everywhere. This doesn't deter any of them. They chase each other around the entire ship, Glimmer teleporting in front of Adora to trip her, Catra launching herself off Adora’s back, Adora summoning the sword in shield form to block the incoming attack.

“That's *cheating*!” shouts Glimmer. “You *know* I'm almost out of teleports!”

“I. I did not know that,” Adora's eyes narrow.

“I did,” Catra mouths, although she totally didn't.

They both launch themselves at Glimmer, who teleports six feet above them and…

collapses. Adora catches her, because of course she does, she's Adora. Adora never lets anyone fall. They both land on the ship's floor, giggling.

Catra feels an increasingly familiar warmth fill her chest as Melog nudges her into the pile.

Bow appears in the door. "*What* is going on out here?"

"Pillow fight," says Catra, even though it hasn't been about the pillow in awhile. It seems like the easiest explanation.

"You had a *pillow fight* and you didn't invite me?" Bow demands.

"Well, it's too late now," Glimmer huffs. "I'm *out of teleports* and anyway, Catra broke the pillow."

"Okay," Bow presses his hand to his forehead like he's not sure whether it's okay to laugh. "I don't actually have a response to that. I'm still stuck on the part where you had a *pillow fight* and didn't invite me."

"You snooze you lose, Arrow Boy," says Catra archly. Then she sneezes on one of the residual feathers. "Achoo!"

"So cute!" Bow's eyes do the heart thing that Catra only pretends to find annoying.

"Hey, Bow?" Adora says. "We're getting a bit stir crazy and Glimmer really needs to recharge. Do you think we could find a place to land for a bit?"

"That's probably a good idea," Bow agrees. "Darla, find us a habitable planet!"

Glimmer shrieks excitedly and runs to hug her partner. Adora leans over to kiss Catra's cheek. "Hey, just checking, does that work for you?"

Catra kisses her. She tastes like warmth. She feels like magic. She's here, and as Catra relaxes into Adora's arms she lets herself start to believe it: Adora's here, and she's not going anywhere.

"I trust you," she whispers. Adora smiles into the kiss. Catra's tail twines around her hips.

“I know,” Adora whispers back. “I know, even when you don't. I'll always be here for you, Catra.”

Catra purrs.

End Notes

I've been wanting to write She-Ra fic for a long time. Special thanks to my wonderful beta reader and fiancee Bambi, watching this show together is one of the cornerstones of our relationship:3💖💗🤍💙💖:3

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!